



FY 2026 UNIVERSITY BUDGET



UNIVERSITY OF
South Carolina

- This page intentionally left blank -

FY2026 Budget Document Table of Contents

Executive Summary	5
System Totals	13
Total Funds	14
Current Funds	19
Tuition and Fees	25
Proposed Fee Schedule	28
SC Public Higher Ed Institutions Comparison	50
Distribution of Tuition	51
Columbia	61
Academic Units	68
McCausland College of Arts and Sciences	69
Education	70
Molinaroli College of Engineering and Computing	71
Hospitality, Retail and Sport Management	72
Joseph F. Rice School of Law	73
Information and Communications	74
Darla Moore School of Business	75
Nursing	76
Pharmacy	77
Arnold School of Public Health	78
Music	79
Social Work	80
Auxiliary Units	81
Athletics	82
Housing	83
Health	84
Parking	85
Support Units	86
Designated Funds	147
Schools of Medicine	149
School of Medicine - Columbia	150
School of Medicine - Greenville	153
Comprehensive Universities	157
Aiken	158
Beaufort	161
Upstate	164
Regional Palmetto Colleges	167
Lancaster	168
Salkehatchie	171
Sumter	174
Union	177
Appendices	181
Model Allocations	182
Glossary	203
Budget Reporting Categories	205
Funding Recommendations	208
Non-Current Funds	209
State Budget Process	221
Delegation of Authority	223

- This page intentionally left blank -

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The University of South Carolina's budget process is a comprehensive planning effort representative of the vision of the University to provide research, teaching, and service for the citizens of the State of South Carolina. The process involves participation beginning at the department level and reaching out to all System Institutions as we develop budgets which will reflect the investments identified to significantly enhance our academic reputation, benefit our students, and contribute to the economic and societal health of our state.

The budget presented herein is based on the best information currently available. The University of South Carolina is in a sound financial and budgetary position. We have adequate cash on-hand for current and special one-time future expenses. We have uncommitted current and future revenues. Major capital projects, such as the Health Sciences Campus, as well as large renovations to identified academic buildings and auxiliary structures are planned and funded. Revenue generation is steady.

Moody's Investor Services has rated USC debt at Aa2 and has provided the outlook for USC as stable. USC Columbia expects to begin FY2026 with unrestricted carryforward budget balances of an estimated \$213 million in academic units and an estimated \$488 million in administrative support units (of which approximately \$160 million is available for the President's strategic one-time commitments). Similarly, restricted funds remain in balance, and auxiliary funds for bookstores, housing, parking, and student health continue to post positive gains.

FY2026 represents the seventh year in a row of tuition freezes for undergraduate resident students. The Columbia undergraduate nonresident rate will increase by a modest 3%. Additionally, a new \$150/term required Athletics auxiliary fee will be assessed to support the strategic direction of the program and to improve student experience. Enrollment for FY2026 will continue to grow with exemplary retention rates and another record-breaking freshman class. Evidence consistently shows the University of South Carolina meets high quality academic delivery standards by prioritizing its dollars on student instruction and student experience.

While the University will continue to have cash and unrestricted resources to support new initiatives and will always have a strong ability to generate revenue, it will be increasingly important to monitor an uncertain economic and political climate while continuing to carefully manage expenses. With strong leadership from our President that cultivates a unified direction embraced by the Trustees, the President's leadership team, and the University community at-large, the University is poised to overcome environmental challenges.

QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

Total Current Funds Revenues and Expenditures by Institution	20
Required Tuition and Fees for System	25
Columbia Academic Units, Summary and by College.....	68
Columbia Auxiliary Units, Summary	81
Columbia Support Units, Summary	86
Other Institution Summaries	149

USC SYSTEM

The USC Columbia total current funds revenue budget comprises 78.3% of the total USC system budget. In FY2026, for the Columbia campus, tuition and fees account for 43.9% of the total budget with state appropriations providing 17.8% of funds. Overall total current funds revenue for the Columbia campus increases by 10.6% in FY2026. Columbia expenditures that directly impact the institutional mission of teaching, research, academic support activity, and public service are 72.3% of total expense at \$1.305 billion.

Across the system, tuition and fees account for 42.0% of the total budget with state appropriations providing 20.8% of funds. The total current fund revenue budget increases by 9.6% at \$201.9 million from FY2025 to FY2026. System wide expenditures that directly impact the institutional mission of teaching, research, academic support activity, and public service are 74.3% of total expenses at \$1.709 billion. Total current funds expenditures for the system are proposed to increase by \$200.2 million.

USC COLUMBIA

State Appropriations USC Columbia will receive an increase in recurring state funds of \$14,436,186 for tuition mitigation and recurring designated support totaling \$12.95 million. Non-recurring support for specific projects including the Battery Center Facility total \$15.2 million.

Salary & Fringe The state budget includes a 2.0% pay plan increase. In addition to the pay plan, the state budget includes an employer health insurance premium increase of 4.6% effective January 1, 2026.

Columbia Tuition Rates

	Proposed Full-Time Tuition per Semester	Increase/ (Decrease) FY2025 to FY2026
Undergraduate Resident	\$ 6,144	\$ 0
Undergraduate Non-Resident	\$ 18,494	\$ 545
Graduate Resident	\$ 6,867	\$ 0
Pharmacy Resident (annual)	\$ 27,372	\$ 0
Law Resident	\$ 10,161	\$ 0
School of Medicine Resident	\$ 21,444	\$ 0

USC Columbia Total Current Funds Budget (Does not include the School of Medicine)

USC Columbia TCF Budget	Approved FY25 Budget - July 1, 2024	Proposed FY26 Budget July 1, 2025*	Percent Change FY2025 to FY2026
Resources	\$ 1,633,023,079	\$ 1,805,860,922	10.6%
Expenditures	\$ 1,632,417,445	\$ 1,805,014,788	10.6%

NOTE: "A" Fund carryforward not budgeted until August 2025, amount not included in FY26 Expenditure Budget.

COMPREHENSIVE UNIVERSITIES AND REGIONAL PALMETTO COLLEGES

State Appropriations The state budget provides the three Comprehensive Universities with a total of \$7.5 million in additional recurring operating funds for tuition mitigation and program enhancements. Non-recurring support for specific projects, maintenance, and renovation at the Comprehensive Universities (non-operating) totaled \$33.6 million. The four Regional Palmetto Colleges receive a total of \$2.3 million in additional recurring state appropriations for tuition mitigation. Non-recurring support for specific projects, maintenance and renovation at the Regional Palmetto Colleges totaled \$15.2 million.

Tuition Rates

	Proposed Full-Time Resident Undergraduate Tuition per Semester	Increase/ (Decrease) FY2025 to FY2026
USC Aiken	\$ 5,199	\$ 0
USC Beaufort	\$ 5,172	\$ 0
USC Upstate	\$ 5,604	\$ 0
USC Regional Palmetto Colleges	\$ 3,579	\$ 0

University of South Carolina System

Proposed Budget FY 2025-2026 Revenues

Revenues

Tuition and Fees	969,432,277
State Appropriations	480,215,166
Grants, Contracts, & Gifts	513,156,278
Sales, Service Educational & Other Sources	83,900,555
Sales & Service Auxiliary Enterprises	259,142,927
Total Revenues	2,305,847,203

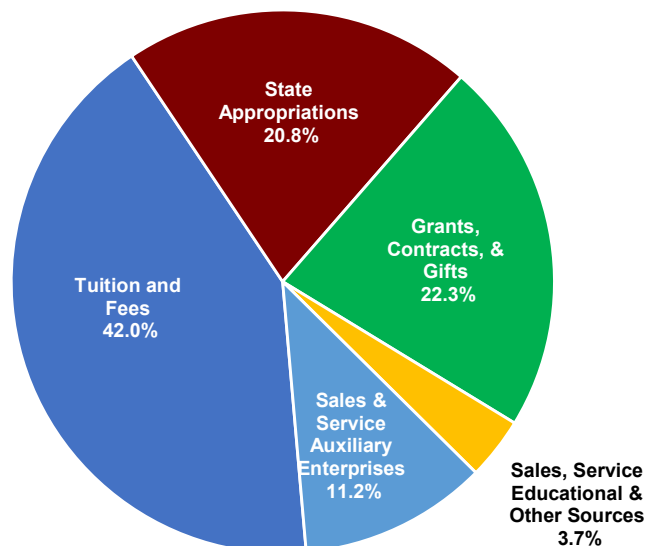
Fall 2024 Headcount Enrollment

Includes undergraduate, graduate and professional students

USC Columbia	38,503
USC Aiken	4,018
USC Beaufort	2,204
USC Upstate	4,907
USC Lancaster	2,591
USC Salkehatchie	787
USC Sumter	1,804
USC Union	1,353
TOTAL	56,167

Proposed Budget FY 2025-2026 Total Current Funds

Revenues



Proposed Budget FY 2025-2026 Expenditures

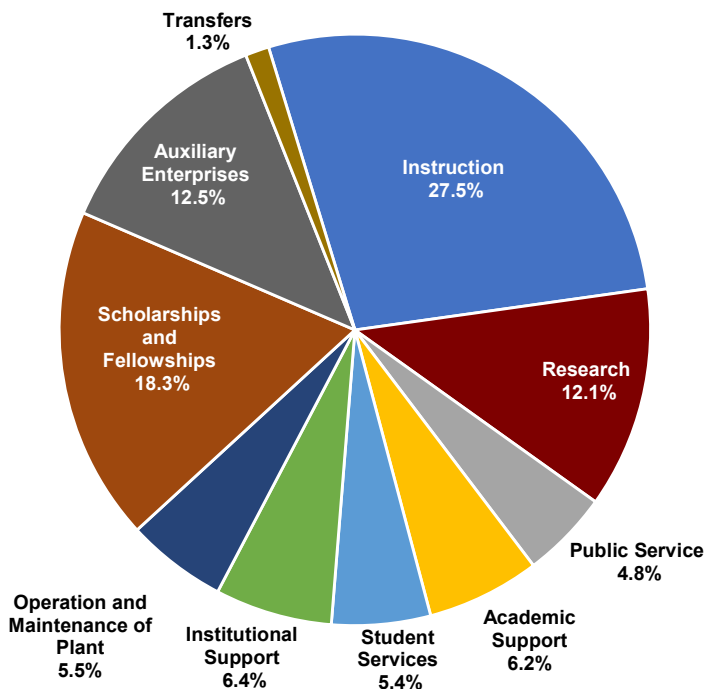
Expenditures

Instruction	632,116,033
Research	277,302,529
Public Service	111,220,067
Academic Support	143,406,250
Student Services	123,737,893
Institutional Support	147,076,778
Operation and Maintenance of Plant	125,562,741
Scholarships and Fellowships	421,279,031
Auxiliary Enterprises	287,539,744
Transfers	30,405,466
Total Expenditures	2,299,646,531

FTE Positions - FY2026

President	1
Classified (authorized)	3,959
Unclassified (authorized)	2,907
TOTAL	6,866

Expenditures



USC System - State Appropriations Estimated Change for FY 2026		APPROPRIATIONS ACT - House	
		APPROPRIATIONS BILL RECURRING	NON-RECURRING BY LOTTERY, PROVISIO AND/OR CAPITAL RESERVE
USC Columbia			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	12,436,186	
	Joseph F. Rice School of Law	5,800,000	
	Battery Center Facility		13,200,000
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	4,653,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
School of Medicine Columbia			
	Neurological Critical Care and Rehabilitation Services in South Carolina	4,500,000	
	Pediatric Brain Health Center	100,000	
	Brain Health Education	100,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	326,350	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
School of Medicine Greenville			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	0	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
USC Aiken			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	2,361,911	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	348,400	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Science Building Enhancement and Modernization		5,280,000
USC Beaufort			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	1,077,571	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	208,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Convocation Center		3,000,000
USC Upstate			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	3,173,940	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	452,400	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Nursing / Health Sciences Building		2,640,000
USC Lancaster			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	597,278	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	111,600	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,320,000
USC Salkehatchie			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	411,995	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	55,800	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,320,000
USC Sumter			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	686,882	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	93,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	-	
	Facilities Management Center		1,980,000
	Collaboration Lab		5,280,000
USC Union			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	608,475	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	68,200	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,320,000
	TOTAL CHANGE IN STATE FUNDS	38,170,988	35,340,000

TOTAL

E & G Operating	31,854,238
Non-Recurring Funds - Capital Reserve, Proviso, etc.	35,340,000
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	6,316,750
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	-
Total	73,510,988

USC System - State Appropriations Estimated Change for FY 2026		APPROPRIATIONS ACT - Senate	
		APPROPRIATIONS BILL RECURRING	NON-RECURRING BY LOTTERY, PROVISIO AND/OR CAPITAL RESERVE
USC Columbia			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	14,436,186	
	Joseph F. Rice School of Law	800,000	
	Center for Civil Rights History & Research	500,000	
	Carolina Internship Pilot Program	2,000,000	
	Pharmacy Research, Oper. & Program Support	3,250,000	
	Center for Outcomes Research & Evaluation	1,000,000	
	Kennedy Pharmacy Innovation Center	400,000	
	Battery Center Facility		1
	Coker College Maintenance Renovation		2,000,000
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	4,653,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	2,550,000	
School of Medicine Columbia			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	0	
	Pay Plan Allocations - TBD	326,350	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - TBD	93,000	
School of Medicine Greenville			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	0	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	0	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0	
USC Aiken			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	1,287,663	
	Cyber/ Engineering Prog. Enhancement	900,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	348,400	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	180,000	
	Science Building Enhancement and Modernization		7,000,000
USC Beaufort			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	1,002,906	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	208,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	80,000	
	Convocation Center		7,000,000
USC Upstate			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	1,920,549	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	452,400	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	230,000	
	Nursing / Health Sciences Building		1
	Maintenance, Renovation & Replacement		10,000,000
USC Lancaster			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	640,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	111,600	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	40,000	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,320,000
USC Salkehatchie			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	314,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	55,800	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	20,000	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,400,000
USC Sumter			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	526,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	93,000	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	30,000	
	Facilities Management Center		1
	Collaboration Lab		1
USC Union			
	E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	362,000	
	Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	68,200	
	Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	20,000	
	Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		2,000,000
	TOTAL CHANGE IN STATE FUNDS	38,899,054	32,720,004

TOTAL

E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	29,339,304
Non-Recurring Funds - Capital Reserve, Proviso, etc.	32,720,004
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	6,316,750
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	3,243,000
Total	71,619,058

USC System - State Appropriations		APPROPRIATIONS ACT - Conference Committee	
USC Columbia			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	14,436,186		
Joseph F. Rice School of Law	5,800,000		
Center for Civil Rights History & Research	500,000		
Carolina Internship Pilot Program	2,000,000		
Pharmacy Research, Oper. & Program Support	3,250,000		
Center for Outcomes Research & Evaluation	1,000,000		
Kennedy Pharmacy Innovation Center	400,000		
Battery Center Facility		13,200,000	
Coker College Maintenance Renovation		2,000,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	4,653,000		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	2,550,000		
School of Medicine Columbia			
Neurological Hospital Operations	4,500,000		
Pediatric Brain Health Center	100,000		
Brain Health Education	100,000		
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	326,350		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	93,000		
School of Medicine Greenville			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	0		
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	0		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	0		
USC Aiken			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	2,361,911		
Cyber/ Engineering Prog. Enhancement	900,000		
Science Building Enhancement and Modernization		8,350,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	348,400		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	180,000		
USC Beaufort			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	1,077,571		
Convocation Center		9,250,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	208,000		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	80,000		
USC Upstate			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	3,173,940		
Recreation and Tourism Mgmt Center		6,000,000	
Maintenance, Renovation & Replacement		10,000,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	452,400		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	230,000		
USC Lancaster			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	640,000		
Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,320,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	111,600		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	40,000		
USC Salkehatchie			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	411,995		
Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		1,400,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	55,800		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	20,000		
USC Sumter			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	686,882		
Facilities Management Center		3,000,000	
Collaboration Lab		5,506,900	
Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		2,000,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	93,000		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	30,000		
USC Union			
E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	608,475		
Maintenance, Renovation, and Replacement		2,000,000	
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	68,200		
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	20,000		

TOTAL

E&G Operating - Tuition Mitigation	41,946,960
Non-Recurring Funds - Capital Reserve, Proviso, etc.	64,026,900
Pay Plan Allocations - Estimate	6,316,750
Fringe Benefits Allocations - Estimate	3,243,000
Total	115,533,610

USC System
FY2026 Budget Development
Annualized Budget Impact - Pay Plan and Fringe Benefits Increases.

"A" Funds Only											
Conference Committee											
Campus	Pay Plan Estimated Impact 2%	Estimated State Appropriations Pay Plan	Balance - USC Funded: Pay Plan	Health Insurance Annualized Impact - 1/1/26 4.6% Increase	Estimated State Appropriations Health Insurance	Balance - USC Funded: Health Insurance	Retirement Increase Impact - SCRS and PORS	Estimated State Appropriations Retirement Increase	Federal Share Estimated	Balance - USC Funded: Retirement Increase	NET Pay Plan & Fringe USC Funded
USC Columbia	\$ 10,300,000	\$ 4,653,000	\$ 5,647,000	\$ 1,650,000	\$ 2,550,000	\$ (900,000)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 4,747,000
USC Columbia - SOM	690,000	\$ 326,350	363,650	93,000	93,000	-	-	-	-	-	363,650
USC Greenville - SOM	220,000	\$ -	220,000	39,000	-	39,000	-	-	-	-	259,000
USC Aiken	680,000	\$ 348,400	331,600	148,000	180,000	(32,000)	-	-	-	-	299,600
USC Beaufort	410,000	\$ 208,000	202,000	89,000	80,000	9,000	-	-	-	-	211,000
USC Upstate	890,000	\$ 452,400	437,600	209,000	230,000	(21,000)	-	-	-	-	416,600
USC Lancaster	190,000	\$ 111,600	78,400	43,000	40,000	3,000	-	-	-	-	81,400
USC Salkehatchie	90,000	\$ 55,800	34,200	27,000	20,000	7,000	-	-	-	-	41,200
USC Sumter	150,000	\$ 93,000	57,000	40,000	30,000	10,000	-	-	-	-	67,000
USC Union	110,000	\$ 68,200	41,800	32,000	20,000	12,000	-	-	-	-	53,800
TOTAL	\$ 13,730,000	\$ 6,316,750	\$ 7,413,250	\$ 2,370,000	\$ 3,243,000	\$ (873,000)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 6,540,250

Total Current Funds											
Conference Committee											
Campus	Pay Plan Estimated Impact 2%	Estimated State Appropriations Pay Plan	Balance - USC Funded: Pay Plan	Health Insurance Annualized Impact - 1/1/26 4.6% Increase	Estimated State Appropriations Health Insurance	Balance - USC Funded: Health Insurance	Retirement Increase Impact - SCRS and PORS	Estimated State Appropriations Retirement Increase	Federal Share Estimated	Balance - USC Funded: Retirement Increase	NET Pay Plan & Fringe USC Funded
USC Columbia	\$ 13,500,000	\$ 4,653,000	\$ 8,847,000	\$ 2,253,000	\$ 2,550,000	\$ (297,000)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 8,550,000
USC Columbia - SOM	1,050,000	326,350	723,650	177,000	93,000	84,000	-	-	-	-	807,650
USC Greenville - SOM	230,000	-	230,000	43,000	-	43,000	-	-	-	-	273,000
USC Aiken	710,000	348,400	361,600	163,000	180,000	(17,000)	-	-	-	-	344,600
USC Beaufort	460,000	208,000	252,000	103,000	80,000	23,000	-	-	-	-	275,000
USC Upstate	1,020,000	452,400	567,600	252,000	230,000	22,000	-	-	-	-	589,600
USC Lancaster	200,000	111,600	88,400	48,000	40,000	8,000	-	-	-	-	96,400
USC Salkehatchie	100,000	55,800	44,200	29,000	20,000	9,000	-	-	-	-	53,200
USC Sumter	160,000	93,000	67,000	42,000	30,000	12,000	-	-	-	-	79,000
USC Union	110,000	68,200	41,800	33,000	20,000	13,000	-	-	-	-	54,800
TOTAL	\$ 17,540,000	\$ 6,316,750	\$ 11,223,250	\$ 3,143,000	\$ 3,243,000	\$ (100,000)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 11,123,250

- This page intentionally left blank -